

【9.4 | Economist】 **Marching** across borders

跨越国境的蚂蚁大军

难度评级：★★★★☆

【考研那些事儿之中东和非洲系列】

今日文章脉络：

男子应走私蚂蚁被捕 (Para. 1)



宠物蚂蚁热潮催生走私黑市 (Para. 2)



这一爱好源于疫情，从社交媒体走向全球 (Para. 3)



市场对珍稀异国品种的需求已远超合法供应能力，

尤其是非洲收获蚁 (Para. 4)



大规模走私蚂蚁或将严重损害当地生态 (Para. 5)



肯尼亚当局已加强措施阻止，

但根本在于遏制相关需求 (Para. 6)

Why **smugglers** are stealing Kenya's ants

为何走私者盯上肯尼亚的蚂蚁

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~】

【Para.1】

It was a **smuggling** operation to **make your skin crawl**. At Nairobi airport earlier this year, Kenyan authorities discovered more than 2,200 **African harvester ants** hidden in a man's luggage. Most were packed inside small plastic tubes **plugged** with **damp** cotton, designed to keep the ants alive for weeks while they made it to their recipients, collectors in China. In April the smuggler was **sentenced** to a year in prison. His **conviction** followed a series of similar cases, including the arrest last year of two Belgian teenagers carrying around 5,000 ants.

- **march v.** /mɑ:rtʃ/ to walk with stiff regular steps like a soldier 齐步走；行进 【考研大纲词汇】

Quick march! (= the order to start marching) （口令）齐步走！

They marched 20 miles to reach the capital. 他们行进了 20 英里才到达首都。

- **smuggler n.** /'smʌglə(r)/ a person who takes goods into or out of a country illegally 走私者

- **smuggle v.** /'smʌgl/ to take, send or bring goods or people secretly and illegally into or out of a country, etc.走私; 私运; 偷运 【考研大纲词汇】
They were caught smuggling diamonds into the country.他们走私钻石入境时被发现。
smuggled drugs 走私的毒品
- **make your skin crawl** *phrase* /krɔ:l/ to make you feel afraid or full of disgust 使人毛骨悚然; 让人起鸡皮疙瘩 【考研大纲词汇】
- **African harvester ants n.** 指分布在非洲、具有收集和储存种子习性的一类蚂蚁
- **plug v.** ~ **sth (up)** to fill a hole with a substance or piece of material that fits tightly into it 堵塞; 封堵 【考研大纲词汇】
He plugged the hole in the pipe with an old rag. s 他用一块旧破布把管子上的那个洞塞住了。
- **damp adj.** slightly wet, often in a way that is unpleasant 潮湿的; 微湿的; 湿气重的 【考研大纲词汇】
The cottage was cold and damp. 这小屋又冷又湿。
- **sentence v.** ~ **sb (to sth)** to say officially in court that sb is to receive a particular punishment 判决; 宣判; 判刑 【考研大纲词汇】
to be sentenced to death/life imprisonment/three years in prison 被判死刑/终身监禁/三年徒刑
- **conviction n.** /kən'vɪkʃn/ ~ **(for sth)** the act of finding sb guilty of a crime in court; the fact of having been found

guilty 判罪；定罪；证明有罪 【考研大纲词汇】

She has six previous convictions for theft.她有六次盗窃前科。

这是一次令人“起鸡皮疙瘩”的走私行动。今年早些时候，肯尼亚当局在内罗毕机场从一名男子的行李中查获了超过 2200 只非洲收获蚁。大部分被分装在小型塑料管内，用湿棉花封堵，这种包装方式可使蚂蚁在被运往在中国的收货人（即收藏者）的途中存活数周之久。今年 4 月，该走私者被判入狱一年。在此之前，已接连发生多起类似案件，包括去年两名比利时青少年因携带约 5000 只蚂蚁而被捕。

【Para.2】

A global craze for pet ants has fuelled a booming black market in live queen ants. An African harvester queen can sell for more than \$200 in the black market (it costs barely \$3 in Kenya). The country has become a **hub** for illegal trading because it has abundant populations of the species, alongside **established** smuggling networks that have long **trafficked** wildlife.

- **hub** n. ~ (of sth) the central and most important part of a particular place or activity (某地或活动的) 中心，核心 【考研大纲词汇】

the commercial hub of the city 城市的商业中心

- **establish** v. /ɪ'stæblɪʃ/ to start or create an organization, a system, etc. that is meant to last for a long time 建立；创立；

设立 【考研大纲词汇】

SYN set up

The committee was established in 1912. 这个委员会创立于 1912 年。

- **traffic** v. to buy and sell sth illegally (非法) 进行...交易, 做...买卖 【考研大纲词汇】

to traffic in drugs 买卖毒品

全球兴起的宠物蚂蚁热潮, 催生了活蚁后黑市交易的繁荣。一只非洲收获蚂蚁后在黑市上可售价逾 200 美元, 而在肯尼亚本地仅不到 3 美元。肯尼亚成为非法交易的中心, 因其境内该物种资源丰富, 同时当地拥有成熟的野生动物走私网络。

【Para.3】

Ant-keeping became a popular pastime during the pandemic as people searched for indoor hobbies. Enthusiasts keep colonies in transparent **formicariums**—**miniature** “ant cities”—where they watch the insects dig **tunnels** and **forage** for food. Social media has helped turn the pastime into a global phenomenon. YouTube channels such as AntsCanada, which has more than 7m subscribers, **narrate** the stories of individual colonies like nature documentaries, from queens founding new nests to battles with rival species.

- **formicarium** n. /ˌfɔːmɪˈkeəriəm/ (pl. **formicaria** /-rre/) an ant's nest, especially one in an artificial container for

purposes of study (尤指供研究用的人造)蚁窝

- **miniature adj.** /'minətʃər/ very small; much smaller than usual 很小的；微型的；小型的 【考研大纲词汇】

miniature roses 小玫瑰花

a rare breed of miniature horses 一种罕见的小矮马

- **tunnel n.** /'tʌnl/ an underground passage made by an animal (动物的) 洞穴通道 【考研大纲词汇】
- **forage v.** /'fɒrɪdʒ/ (especially of an animal 尤指动物) to search for food 觅 (食)
- **narrate v.** /nə'reɪt/ to speak the words that form the text of a documentary film or programme 给 (纪录片或节目) 作解说

The film was narrated by Andrew Sachs.这部电影是由安德鲁·萨克斯解说的。

疫情期间，人们纷纷寻求室内娱乐，养蚁由此成为一项广受欢迎的消遣活动。爱好者将蚁群养在透明蚁窝——微型“蚂蚁城”——之中，观察它们挖掘隧道、搜寻食物。社交媒体将这种消遣活动推向全球。YouTube 上诸如“AntsCanada”等频道拥有超过 700 万订阅者；这类频道会以自然纪录片式的旁白讲述各个蚁群的故事，包括蚁后建立新巢，以及蚂蚁与竞争物种的争斗。

【Para.4】

Most ant-keeping is perfectly legal. Specialist **dealers breed** the insects and sell them in licensed shops. But demand for rare and **exotic** ants

has **outpaced** legal supply. African harvester ants are especially prized because they are among the world's largest ant species and display complex social behaviours, making them “the tigers of the ant world”, says Dino Martins, an **entomologist** and evolutionary biologist based in Kenya.

- **dealer n.** /'di:lə(r)/ a person whose business is buying and selling a particular product 交易商；贸易商 【考研大纲词汇】
an art/antique dealer 艺术品经销商；古董商

- **breed v.** to keep animals or plants in order to produce young ones in a controlled way 饲养，培育（动植物）【考研大纲词汇】

The rabbits are bred for their long coats. 饲养兔子是为了获取他们的长毛。

- **exotic adj.** /ɪg'zɒtɪk/ from or in another country, especially a tropical one; seeming exciting and unusual because it is connected with foreign countries 来自异国（尤指热带国家）的；奇异的；异国情调的；异国风味的 【考研大纲词汇】

brightly-coloured exotic flowers/plants/birds 色彩鲜艳的异国花卉/植物/鸟儿

- **outpace v.** to go, rise, improve, etc. faster than sb/sth （在速度上）超过；比...快

SYN outstrip

He easily outpaced the other runners. 他轻而易举地超过了其他赛跑选手。

- **entomologist n.** /,entə'mɒ:lədʒɪst/ a zoologist who studies

insects 昆虫学家，昆虫学者

绝大多数蚂蚁饲养行为完全合法。专业繁育者养殖蚂蚁，并通过持证商店进行销售。然而，市场对珍稀异国品种的需求已远超合法供应能力。肯尼亚昆虫学家、进化生物学家迪诺·马丁斯 (Dino Martins) 称非洲收获蚁尤为受青睐，因其属于全球最大的蚂蚁物种之一，且表现出复杂的社会行为，使其堪称“蚂蚁世界的老虎”。

【Para.5】

Scientists worry that removing large numbers of ants could damage Kenyan ecosystems. Traffickers target queens because each colony has just one breeding female. She typically lives for 25 years and can produce a colony of thousands of workers. Ants play a **crucial** role in east Africa's **savannahs**. As they forage, they collect and **disperse** grass seeds, helping maintain the diverse grasslands on which much wildlife depends. The ants' vast underground nests add oxygen to the soil and create nutrient-rich hotspots where plants grow more easily. Meanwhile many other animals, such as **pangolins**, **feast** on the ants themselves.

- **crucial** **adj.** /'kru:ʃl/ ~ (to/for sth) ~ (that...) extremely important, because it will affect other things 至关重要的；关键性的 【考研大纲词汇】

SYN critical essential

a crucial factor/issue/decision 关键性的因素/问题/决定

Parents play a crucial role in preparing their child for school.
父母对孩子做好上学的准备起着至关重要的作用。

- **savannah** n. /sə'vænə/ a wide flat open area of land, especially in Africa, that is covered with grass but has few trees (尤指非洲的) 稀树草原
- **disperse** v. /dɪ'spɜːrs/ to spread or to make sth spread over a wide area 散布；散发；传播 【考研大纲词汇】

SYN scatter

The seeds are dispersed by the wind. 这些种子由风传播。

- **pangolin** n. /'pæŋgəlɪn/ a small animal from Africa or Asia that eats insects, and has a long nose, tongue and tail, and hard scales on its body 穿山甲, 有鳞食蚁兽 (见于非洲和亚洲)
- **feast** v. ~ (on sth) to eat a large amount of food, with great enjoyment 尽情享用 (美味佳肴) 【考研大纲词汇】
(常用短语 feast your eyes (on sb/sth), to look at sb/sth and get great pleasure 尽情欣赏；大饱眼福；赏心悦目)

科学家担忧, 大规模捕捉蚂蚁可能对肯尼亚生态系统造成损害。走私者之所以瞄准蚁后, 是因为每个蚁群只有一只具备繁殖能力的雌性。蚁后通常可存活 25 年, 并能繁衍出包含数千只工蚁的庞大群落。蚂蚁在东非稀树草原中发挥着关键作用: 它们在觅食过程中收集并播撒草籽, 有助于维持草原多样化, 而众多野生动物的生存正依赖于草原。蚂蚁庞大的地下巢穴能增加土壤含氧量, 并形成养分富集区, 使植物更易生长。此外, 穿山甲等许多动物也以蚂蚁为食。

【Para.6】

Authorities are **scrambling** to stop the illegal **exodus**. Kenya Wildlife Service has pushed for tougher **penalties** and **stepped up** inspections at airports. But **conservationists** say the recent **seizures** are probably only the tip of the anthill. And interceptions **address** the trade only after the damage has been done. Alongside tougher enforcement, Mr Martins argues, authorities should educate collectors and local communities about the insects' **ecological** importance. Unless demand falls, smugglers will find new ways to keep ants marching across borders.

- **scramble v.** ~ (for sth) to push, fight or compete with others in order to get or to reach sth 争抢；抢占；争夺 【考研大纲词汇】

The audience scrambled for the exits. 观众竞相朝出口拥去。

- **exodus n.** /'eksədəs/ ~ (from...) (to...) a situation in which many people leave a place at the same time (大批人同时) 离开，外出，出去

the mass exodus from Paris to the country in the summer
夏日大批人从巴黎外出到乡村

- **penalty n.** /'penəlti/ ~ (for sth) a punishment for breaking a law, rule or contract 惩罚；处罚；刑罚 【考研大纲词汇】
to impose a penalty 予以惩罚

- **step up phrase** to increase the amount, speed, etc. of sth 增

加，提高（数量、速度等）【考研大纲词汇】

He has stepped up his training to prepare for the race. 他为准
准备那场比赛加强了训练。

- **conservationist** n. /ˌkɒnsə'veɪʃənɪst/ a person who takes an active part in the protection of the environment 自然环境保护主义者

a meeting of local conservationists 当地自然环境保护主义者的会议

- **seizure** n. /'si:ʒə(r)/ ~ (of sth) the use of legal authority to take sth from sb; an amount of sth that is taken in this way 起获；没收；充公；起获的赃物；没收的财产

The court ordered the seizure of his assets. 法庭下令没收其财产。

- **address** v. to think about a problem or a situation and decide how you are going to deal with it 设法解决；处理；对付 【考研大纲词汇】

Your essay does not address the real issues. 你的论文没有论证实质问题。

- **ecological** adj. /ˌi:kə'lɒdʒɪkl/ connected with the relation of plants and living creatures to each other and to their environment 生态的；生态学的

We risk upsetting the ecological balance of the area. 我们有可能破坏这个地区的生态平衡。

当局正加紧行动，阻止这场非法的大规模“蚂蚁外流”。肯尼亚野生动物管理局已推动并加大处罚力度，加强了机场的查验

工作。但环保人士指出，近期查获的案件很可能只是蚁丘的一角。而且，拦截措施的执行仅限于损害发生之后。马丁斯先生认为，除加强执法外，当局还应向收藏者和当地社区普及这些昆虫的生态重要性。若不遏制需求，走私者必将寻得新的途径，使蚂蚁继续跨境流出。

August 29TH- September 4TH | Middle East & Africa

➤ 今日翻译作业

(Para. 3) YouTube channels such as AntsCanada, which has more than 7m subscribers, narrate the stories of individual colonies like nature documentaries, from queens founding new nests to battles with rival species.

（下一页提供句子分析）

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 3. YouTube channels such as AntsCanada, which has more than 7m subscribers, narrate the stories of individual colonies like nature documentaries, from queens founding new nests to battles with rival species. YouTube 上诸如 “AntsCanada” 等频道拥有超过 700 万订阅者; 这类频道会以自然纪录片式的旁白讲述各个蚁群的故事, 包括蚁后建立新巢, 以及蚂蚁与竞争物种的争斗。

主句		定语从句
YouTube channels	such as AntsCanada,	which has more
主语	同位语	从句主语 谓语 宾语
than 7m subscribers,	narrate	the stories of individual
	谓语	宾语
colonies	like nature documentaries,	from queens
	方式状语	列举同位语
founding new nests to battles with rival species.		

句子分析:

主句：

主语-YouTube channels ; 同位语-such as AntsCanada, ;

(定语从句：

引导词-which 指代 AntsCanada; 谓语-has; 宾语- more than 7m subscribers,)

谓语-narrate; 宾语- the stories of individual colonies ; 方

式状语, 修饰 narrate, 表示 “像自然纪录片那样” -like

nature documentaries, ; 列举同位语, 进一步说明故事的内

容范围, 从 “蚁后建巢” 到 “与竞争物种的战斗” -from

queens founding new nests to battles with rival species.

➤ 写作积累

Para.4 African harvester ants are especially prized because they are **among the world' s largest ant species** and **display complex social behaviours**, making them “the tigers of the ant world” , ...

这句话集中了多条信息，表达较为简练，例如：

1) they are among the world' s largest ant species 这句话跟 they are one of the largest ant species 的意思是差不多的，都是指“处于.....范围之内”或者“是.....之一”，但相对于 one of, among 会显得更加中立一点，而且会使表达更加简洁。

2) display complex social behaviours 中的 display 这个单词用得也比较准确，如果用 have，则会显得过于肯定，而用 display 则会更倾向于“只是显现出.....”，而非确切指“拥有.....”，例：

These statistics display a definite trend. 这些统计数据表现出一种明显的趋势。

Para.6 But conservationists say the recent seizures are probably only **the tip of the anthill**.

这里的 the tip of the anthill 仿照 the tip of the iceberg, 是作者的自创, 但同样含有 “只是.....的一角” 这个意思。写作中有时也可以通过替换主题名词, 来体现一致性, 例: Unless we're all a lot more careful, the people who have died so far will be just the tip of the iceberg. 除非我们大家都更加小心, 否则迄今为止已经死去的人数将只是冰山一角。